
Session 19: Mastering Email From Basics to Best Practices

Presented by

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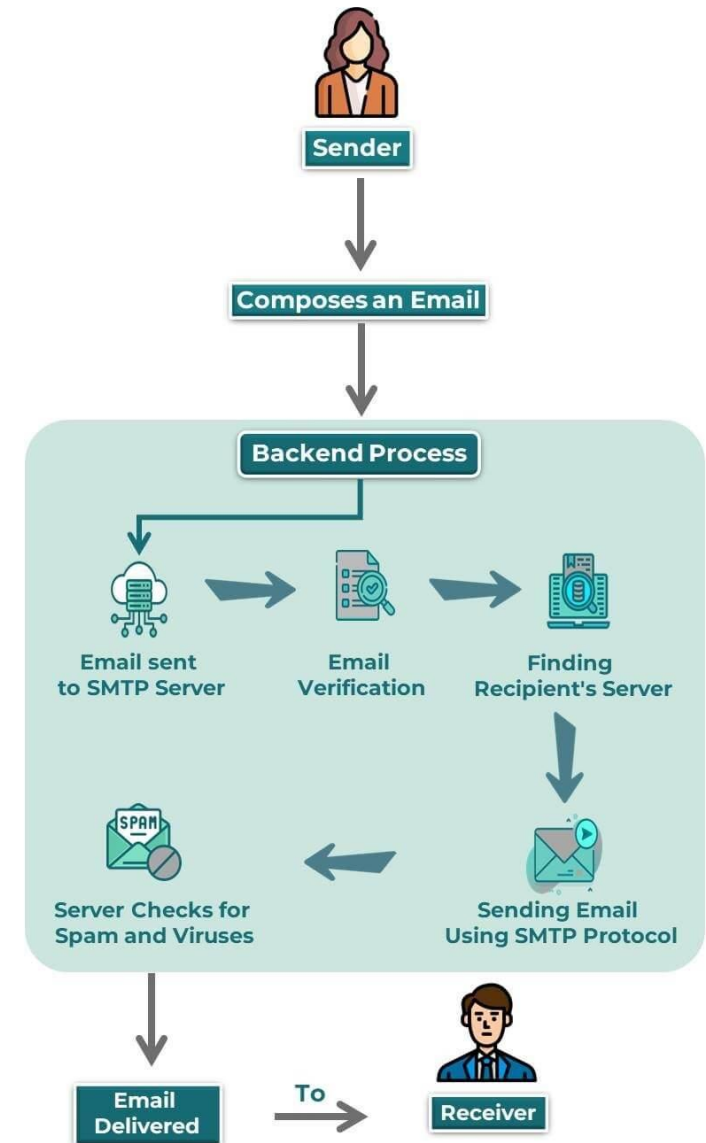


Session Objectives

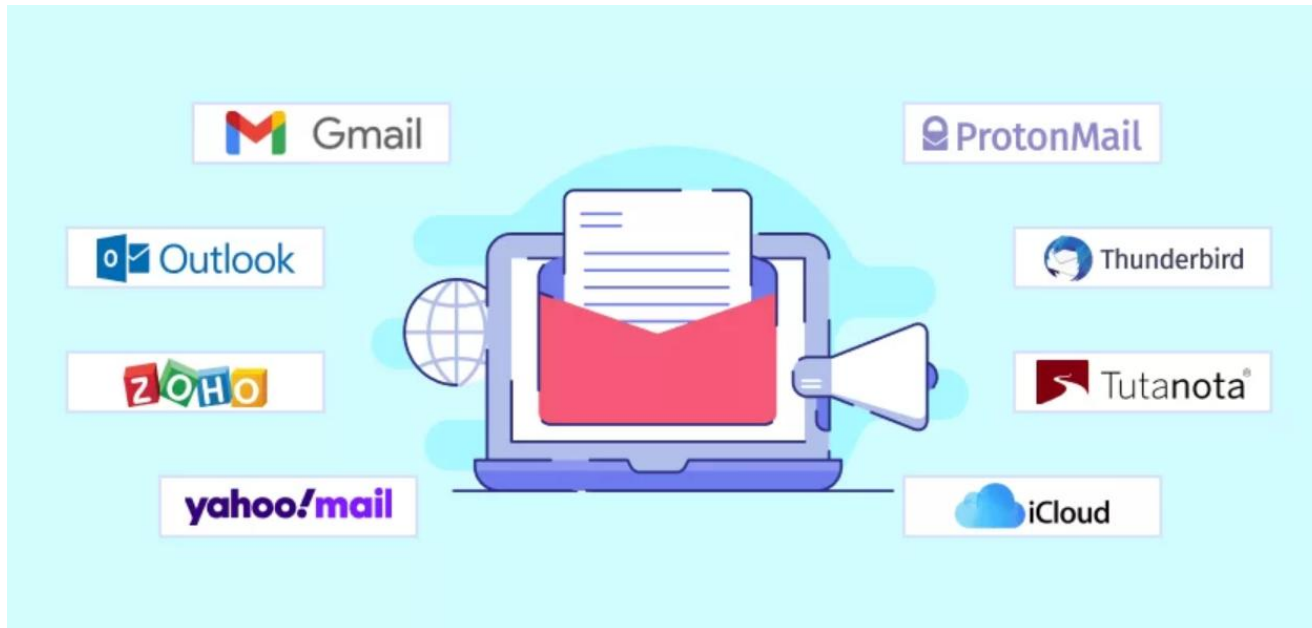
- Understand what email is and how it works.
- Create, send, and manage emails effectively.
- Use CC, BCC, attachments, and formatting.
- Follow professional email etiquette.
- Manage inbox using folders, filters, and labels.
- Recognize and avoid phishing & spam.

What is Email?

- Definition: Electronic mail (email) is a method of exchanging digital messages over the internet.
- Key points:
 - Requires an email address (e.g., yourname@example.com).
 - Uses protocols like SMTP (sending), POP/IMAP (receiving).
- Advantages: Speed, global reach, cost-effective, trackable.



Popular Email Providers



- Free:
Gmail, Outlook,
Yahoo Mail, ProtonMail.
- Paid/Business:
Microsoft 365, Google Workspace,
Zoho Mail.
- Key differences:
 - storage space
 - Features
 - Integration
 - security

Creating an Email Account (Gmail Example)

1. Go to mail.google.com
2. Click "Create Account" → "For myself" or "For business"
3. Fill in personal info
(name, username, password)
4. Add phone & recovery email for security
5. Agree to terms & verify account

Use your real name – helps identify you easily.

Avoid nicknames/slang – keeps it professional.

Use periods, underscores, or numbers if your name is taken.

Keep it short and simple – easy to remember and type.

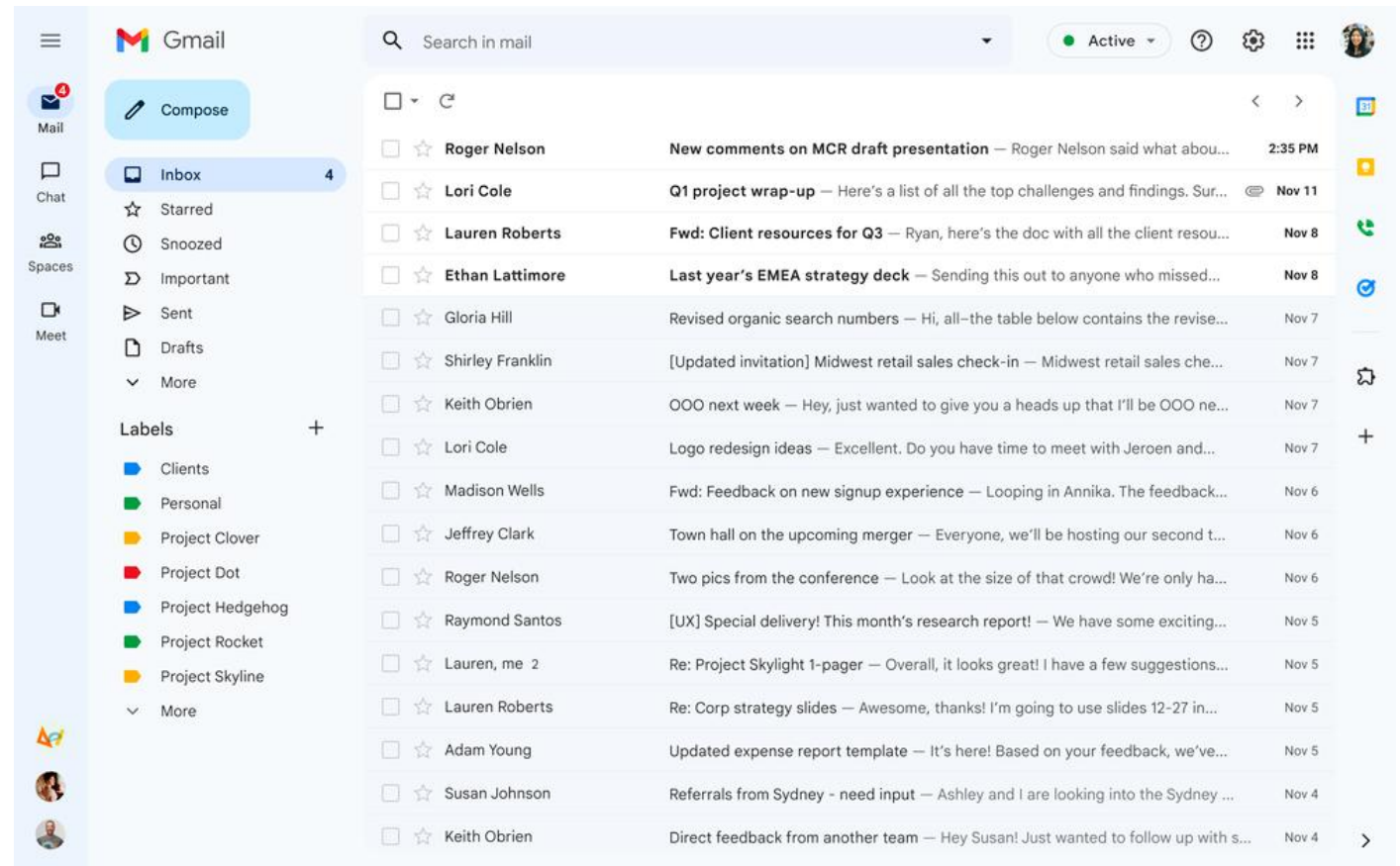
Avoid special characters – they can cause issues.

Choose a reliable provider – e.g., Gmail, Outlook, Yahoo.

Avoid random numbers/words – looks unprofessional.

Email Interface Overview

- **Inbox:** All received emails
- **Compose:** Create new email
- **Labels/Folders:** Organize emails
- **Search bar:** Find messages
- **Settings:** Personalize experience



Composing an Email

Sections of an email:

- **To:** Main recipient(s)
- **CC (Carbon Copy):** Sends a copy to others
- **BCC (Blind Carbon Copy):** Sends a copy secretly
- **Subject line:** Short summary (max ~8 words)
- **Body:** Message content (paragraphs, bullet points)
- **Attachments:** Files, documents, images
- **Signature:** Your contact details at the bottom

Heading

- Recipient's email address
- Copy of the message
- Blind carbon copy
- Subject line

To: kdorley@notahighschool.net
Cc:
Bcc:
Subject: Email Do's and Dont's

Dear Mr. Dorley,

I have researched current email etiquette and have compiled a list of do's and don't for professional and business email messages.

Do's:

1. Obtain the correct email address of your recipient.
2. Use Cc: when the message should be shared with another user.
3. Use Bcc: when emailing a number of people to protect private email addresses. This will keep the entire address list hidden from other recipients.
4. Include a message in the subject line.
5. Use a formal salutation.
6. Use a complimentary closing followed by your contact information, such as mailing address, telephone number, and email address.
7. Use proper spelling and grammar. Proofread and spellcheck before you hit send.

Don'ts:

1. Avoid using emoticons when emailing a teacher, employer, or colleague.
2. Avoid long, wordy emails. Keep your message concise and to the point.
3. Eliminate special abbreviations such as LOL or BTW.
4. Avoid attaching files in formats that the recipient will be unable to open. Consider sending PDF versions of files or earlier versions of Word documents.

Complimentary Closing

Sincerely,

Natalie Kanter
nkanter@notahighschool.net
617-555-2495

Salutation/Greeting

Message Body

Signature

Email Formatting Tips

- Use short paragraphs for readability
- Highlight key points in bold or italics
- Avoid ALL CAPS (seems like shouting)Use numbered/bullet lists for clarity
- Maintain professional fonts (Arial, Calibri)
- Limit color use

Writing Subject Lines That Get Read

- The Problem: Vague subject lines get ignored in busy offices.

- The Formula:

[Action or FYI] + Main Topic + Date/Deadline

- Examples:

✗ Bad: "Question"

✓ Good: "Action Required: Approval for New Lab Computers by Friday"

✗ Bad: "Sick"

✓ Good: "Out of Office: Nimal Perera - Sick Leave (March 24)"

✗ Bad: "Meeting"

✓ Good: "FYI: Time Change for Tomorrow's Marketing Meeting"

Professional Email Etiquette

- ✓ Be clear and concise
- ✓ Use polite greetings and closings
- ✓ Proofread before sending
- ✓ Reply within 24 hours when possible
- ✓ Keep attachments small (under 25 MB)

- ✗ Avoid slang, emojis in formal emails
- ✗ Never forward chain mails

The image shows a 'New message' email window with a blue header bar containing a yellow hexagonal logo and the text 'New message'. The email content is as follows:

To: hiring.manager@company.com

Subject: Application for Marketing Coordinator Position

Dear Mr. Thompson, **Greeting**

I hope this email finds you well. **Opening**

Intro

I am writing to formally apply for the Marketing Coordinator position advertised on your company's careers page. With a strong background in digital marketing and campaign analytics, I believe I can contribute effectively to your team.

In my previous role at BrightPath Media, I led multiple successful social media campaigns, increasing engagement by 40% over six months. My experience in content creation, email marketing, and using tools such as Google Analytics and HubSpot aligns closely with the requirements of your role. **Main Body**

I have attached my resume and cover letter for your review. I would be grateful for the opportunity to further discuss how my background and enthusiasm could benefit your marketing team.

Thank you for considering my application. I look forward to hearing from you. **Closing**

Best regards,
Layla Morgan **Sign-off**

At the bottom of the window, there is a toolbar with icons for deleting, inserting images, text formatting (A), and links, followed by a large blue 'SEND' button.

Creating an Email Signature

Purpose: Add your name, role, and contact info automatically to every email.

Steps (Gmail Example):

- Go to **Settings** (⚙ icon) → **See all settings**.
- Click on the **General** tab.
- Scroll to **Signature** and click **Create New**.
- Enter your details:
 - Full Name
 - Job Title / Organization
 - Contact Number
 - Website or social links (optional)
- Format text (bold, italics, links, logo).
- Set signature defaults for *New Emails* and *Replies*.
- Save changes.
- **Tip:** Keep it professional and avoid too many colors or large images.

My picture:

[Learn more](#)



Your Google profile picture is
You can change your picture

Create contacts for auto-complete:

- ☒ When I send a message to a new person, create contacts for me.
☐ I'll add contacts myself

Importance signals for ads:

You can view and change your preferences

Signature:

(appended at the end of all outgoing messages)

[Learn more](#)

No signatures

[+ Create new](#)

Personal level indicators:

- ☒ No indicators
☐ Show indicators - Display an arrow

Snippets:

- ☒ Show snippets - Show snippets of text
☐ No snippets - Show subject only.

Out-of-Office AutoReply:

(sends an automated reply to incoming messages. If a contact sends you several messages, this automated reply will be sent at most once every 4 days)

[Learn more](#)

- ☒ Out of Office AutoReply off
☐ Out of Office AutoReply on

First day:

Subject:

Message:

The Ultimate Time Saver: Templates

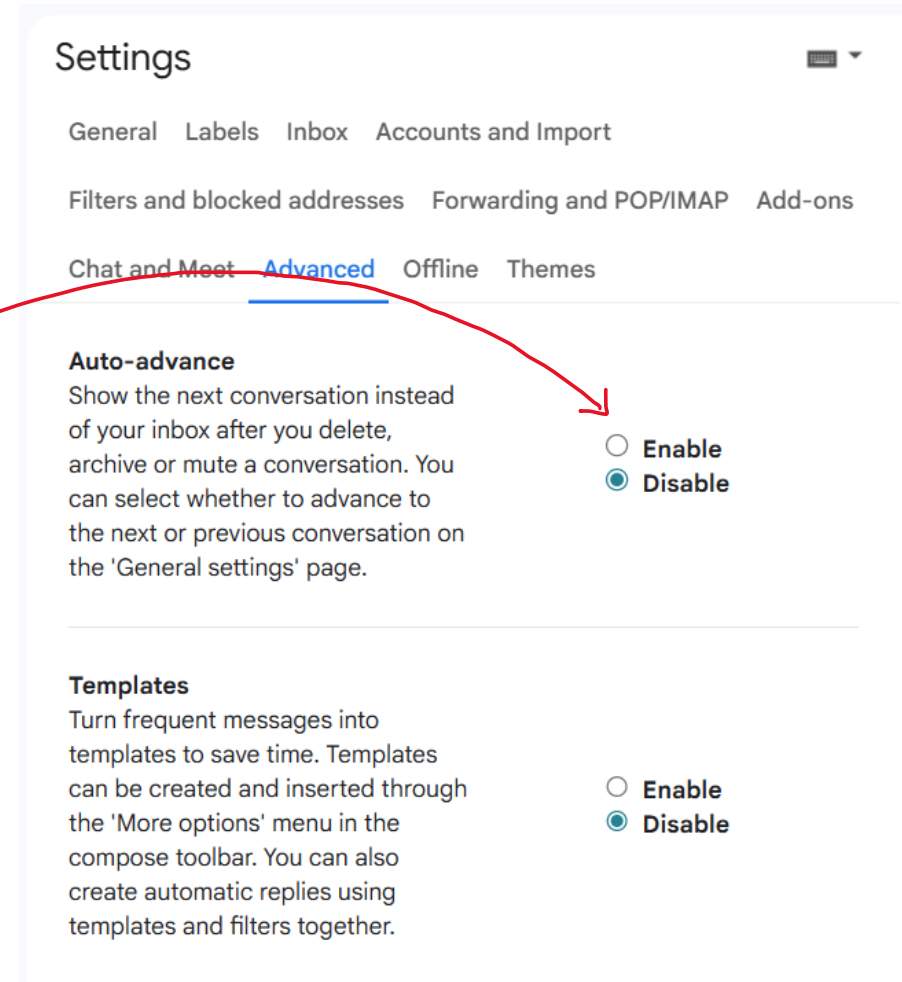
- What are they? "Canned responses" you can save and insert with two clicks.
- Perfect for HR, Sales, and Admin roles.

How to Enable (Gmail):

1. Click Settings (⚙️) → See all settings.
2. Go to the Advanced tab.
3. Next to Templates, click Enable, then Save Changes.

How to Use:

- Type your perfect email.
- Click the 3 dots (⋮) at the bottom of the compose window.
- Select Templates → Save draft as template → Save as new template.



Undo Send Time

- Purpose: Allows you to cancel sending an email for a few seconds after clicking "Send."
- Why use it: Helps avoid sending emails with typos, missing attachments, or wrong recipients.
- How to set it (Gmail example):
 1. Click Settings (⚙ icon) → See all settings.
 2. In the General tab, find Undo Send. 
 3. Choose a cancellation period (5, 10, 20, or 30 seconds).
 4. Click Save Changes.
- Tip: During the delay, a "Undo" button will appear after sending — click it to cancel.

Language:

Gmail display language: English (UK)

☒ Enable input tools - Use various text input too

☒ Right-to-left editing support off

☐ Right-to-left editing support on

Maximum page size:

Show 50 conversations per page

Undo Send:

Send cancellation period: 5 seconds

Default reply behaviour:

☐ Reply

[Learn more](#)

☐ Reply all

Hover actions:

☒ Enable hover actions - Quickly gain access to

☐ Disable hover actions

Send and Archive:

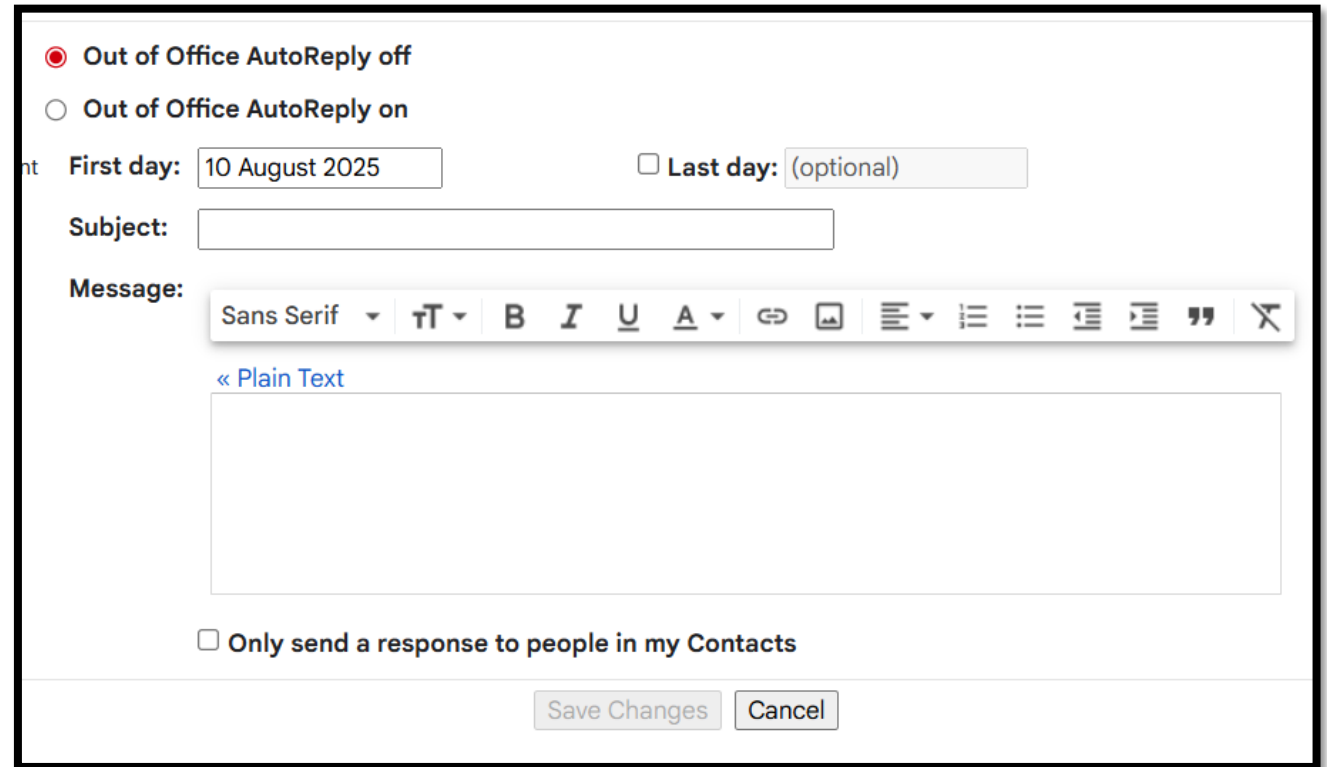
[Learn more](#)

☐ Show "Send & Archive" button in reply

☒ Hide "Send & Archive" button in reply

Vacation (Out-of-Office) Emails

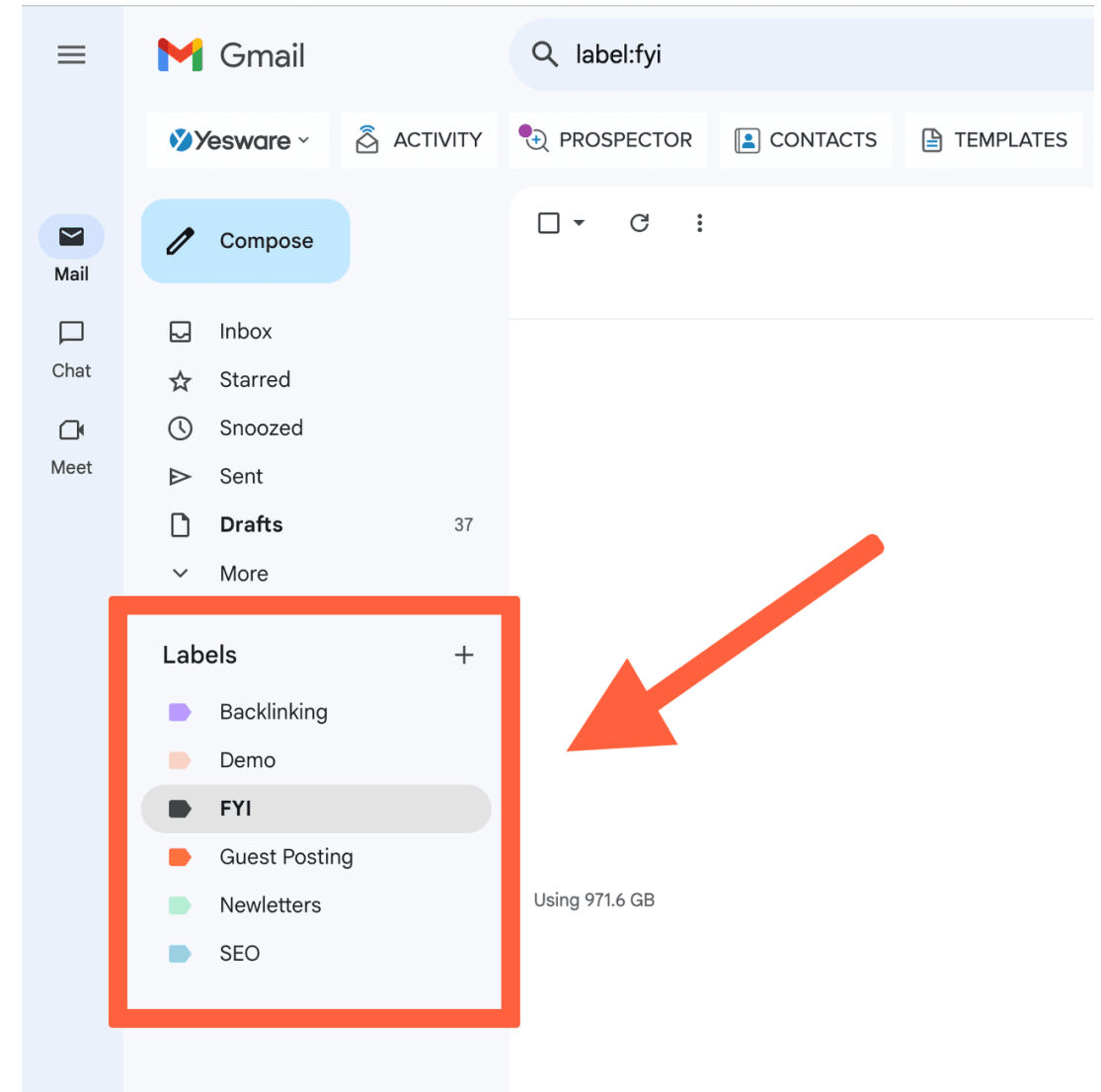
- **Purpose:** Auto-reply when you're away.
- **Key Elements:** Dates, reason (optional), alternative contact.
- **Setup:**
 - Go to *Settings* → *Out of Office / Automatic Replies*.
 - Set start & end dates.
 - Write your auto-reply message.
- **Example:**
"I am away from [date] to [date]. For urgent matters, contact [Name, Email]."



The screenshot shows the 'Out of Office' settings window in Microsoft Outlook. At the top, there are two radio buttons: 'Out of Office AutoReply off' (which is selected) and 'Out of Office AutoReply on'. Below these, there are input fields for 'First day:' (containing '10 August 2025') and 'Last day:' (containing '(optional)'). A 'Subject:' field is also present. The 'Message:' section features a rich text editor with a toolbar containing options for font face (Sans Serif), font size, bold, italic, underline, text color, link, insert picture, bulleted list, numbered list, decrease indent, increase indent, quote, and undo. Below the toolbar is a text area with the placeholder '<< Plain Text'. At the bottom, there is a checkbox for 'Only send a response to people in my Contacts' and two buttons: 'Save Changes' and 'Cancel'.

Inbox Management

- Create folders/labels for subjects or projects
- Use filters to auto-sort incoming mail
- Archive instead of deleting for future reference
- Mark spam to block unwanted messages



Security & Privacy

- Enable 2FA (Two-Factor Authentication)
- Never click unknown links
- Check sender email carefully (phishing often mimics real addresses)
- Don't send sensitive info over plain email
- Keep backup of important emails

Security

Settings and recommendations to help you keep your account secure

You have security tips

Security tips found in the Security Check-up



[Review security tips](#)

Recent security activity

No security activity or alerts in the last 28 days

How you sign in to Google

Make sure that you can always access your Google Account by keeping this information up to date

 2-Step Verification	2-Step Verification is off	>
 Passkeys and security keys	Start using passkeys	>

Common Mistakes to Avoid

- Sending without proofreading
- Forgetting attachments
- Using vague subject lines
- Replying to all unnecessarily
- Sharing private info to the wrong recipient

Hands-On Activity

- **Example Scenario:** *"You are an IT Support Intern. The campus Wi-Fi has gone down, and you need to email the Campus Director (Ravindu) to explain the situation. You must CC your IT Manager, use a clear subject line, and keep it professional."*
- ravindunisalsooriyaarachchi@gmail.com
- ravindusooriyaarachchi@gmail.com
- **Task 2:** Organize inbox into at least 2 folders and apply a filter.

Recap

- Email basics, providers, interface
- Writing professional messages
- Managing inbox efficiently
- Staying safe online

Send Me Your Thoughts (Anonymously!)

*Scan the QR code and share your
questions or feedback*

<https://forms.gle/oKg7kAJNLI3Gcv7n7>

Thank You!

